VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 16, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

"Turns out the future does have flying cars"

Elon Musk's Tesla showed a Roadster on Thursday night that clung upside down to a ramp, flipped through the air on SpaceX thrusters and jumped a row of Tesla vehicles at a SpaceX site in McGregor, Texas. He said production starts in 2028. Earlier, a Falcon 9 had launched a classified Space Force payload from California. Musk said the Star Mind computer SpaceX is building with Nvidia "will reach volume production next year." A federal filing showed his $158 million made him the main donor behind a record quarter for the Republicans' Senate super PAC. Ukraine said its Starlink service is back to full strength. SpaceXAI testifies to the New York City Council at 10 a.m. EDT today.

I · TESLA

A Roadster that flies, two years from production

"Success is not certain, but excitement is," Musk posted as the stream began.

0.81s	2028	$250,000
claimed 0–60 mph in a timed run at the event	production start Musk named on stage	deposit for the Thrust version; $50,000 for Performance

The white two-seater drove upside down on a ramp using a suction system, turned in the air and landed on built-in thrusters, then jumped a truck and other vehicles, Reuters reported. "This is the culmination of incredible work by Tesla and SpaceX engineers working closely together to make something that you haven't seen in any movie," Musk told the crowd. Range is more than 300 miles, less than half the 2017 promise; no price was given. The invite-only Rocket version is "not approved for public road use," Tesla says.



The 2017 Roadster prototype outside Tesla's shareholder meeting and Battery Day on Sept. 22, 2020. The car shown Thursday has a new body.
PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0

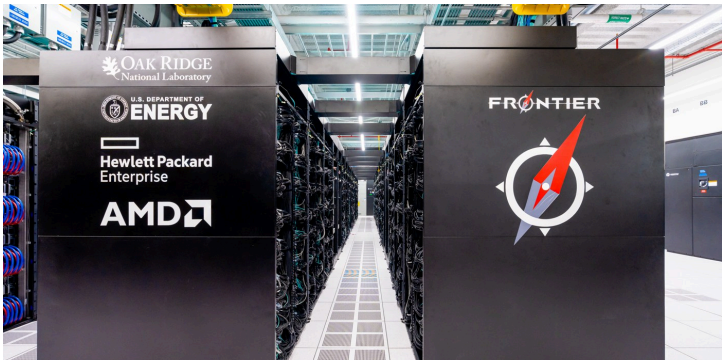
"Turns out the future does have flying cars," Musk posted after the show. When a post noted that 0.81 seconds "is over 3.3 Gs," he replied, "You're right, we can do better." He thanked Google's Sundar Pichai: "It's such an honor working with incredible engineers" (post), and of the first Roadster, launched on Falcon Heavy in 2018, wrote: "My OG Roadster is still orbiting Mars and Earth." Tesla shares rose 5% in premarket trading Friday, Reuters reported.

II · SPACEX, GROK & X

"Maybe more than 10GW"

Musk and Jensen Huang talked up a computer for orbit; a Falcon 9 flew for the Space Force.

"Old friends are the best friends. Jensen rocks," Musk posted, quoting Nvidia's chief executive. "The Star Mind computer being co-engineered by SpaceX and Nvidia is far better than almost anyone expects and will reach volume production next year." Huang had said on the BG2 podcast that the two companies are designing "a new type of server" for data centers in space, Tesla News Wire reported. To a post saying he wants 10 gigawatts of compute by the end of 2027, Musk answered, "Maybe more than 10GW."



Cabinets of the Frontier supercomputer at Oak Ridge National Laboratory in Tennessee.

PHOTO: OLCF AT ORNL / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0

"Never seen anything grow as fast as @Grok @Bot! And there is no free tier," he wrote, and on Anthropic opening its safety practices to outside evaluators: "SpaceX will probably do the same." A Falcon 9 launched the classified USSF-481 mission from Vandenberg at 8:01 p.m. EDT, and its booster landed on a drone ship (Spaceflight Now). Cargo Dragon docked at the space station Thursday morning, SpaceX said.

III · POLITICS & UKRAINE

$158 million for the Senate fight

A filing put numbers on Musk's giving; Kyiv said its satellite service was restored.

Musk's $158 million, given in September in contributions of $75 million and $83 million through a Texas PAC backing Republican Ken Paxton, helped the Senate Leadership Fund raise a record $272.9 million in the third quarter, CNBC reported from a Federal Election Commission filing Thursday.

Ukraine's Starlink and Starshield services were restored to full capacity after being slowed for more than a day, a Ukrainian official told Axios; it is still unclear who ordered the restrictions.

On the record

Musk spoke on stage at the Roadster event; SpaceXAI goes before city lawmakers today.

Coming up

Today, 10 a.m. EDT: SpaceXAI testifies before the New York City Council's Committee on Technology in an oversight hearing on the risks of artificial intelligence (Council calendar). The company skipped an October 5 hearing and agreed to appear after the Council said it would go to court over its subpoena, CNBC reported. Wednesday, October 21: Tesla's third-quarter results, with a webcast at 5:30 p.m. EDT (8-K).

Looking back October 15, 2026

On stage in McGregor, Musk said of the Roadster's top speed, "I think you've got to crack halfway to the speed of sound" (Reuters). Earlier he wrote that the new car is "beyond movies, beyond imagination, beyond human, yet still made by humans on Earth."

Takeaways

1. **Tesla's new Roadster flew, drove inverted and hit 60 mph in a claimed 0.81 seconds.**
2. **Musk says Roadster production starts in 2028.**
3. **Star Mind, built with Nvidia, will reach volume production next year, Musk said.**
4. **Musk's $158 million drove a record quarter for the GOP Senate super PAC.**
5. **SpaceXAI testifies to the New York City Council at 10 a.m. EDT today.**

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk and @SpaceX.

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